# Diversity Statement

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As a teacher and researcher, I am deeply committed to promoting diversity, equity, and inclusion in STEM fields. I firmly believe that diversity is crucial to ensuring that no matter what individuals' background or identity, they have an equal opportunity to succeed in STEM and contribute to the advancement of the field. Toward this end, I am actively involved in the Broadening Participation in Computing (BPC) initiative, which aims to increase the participation and success of underrepresented groups in computing. Through my involvement in BPC initiatives, I have had the opportunity to mentor students, organize events and workshops, and engage in other activities that promote diversity and inclusion in STEM.

## 1 Teaching

As a teacher, I am committed to creating a positive and engaging learning environment that supports the growth and development of all students. I believe that each student is unique and has their own learning style and needs, and I strive to tailor my teaching approach to meet the individual needs of my students. Additionally, I encourage my students to ask questions, explore new ideas, and work together to find solutions by fostering a culture of inquiry and collaboration.

## 2 Research

In my research, I am interested in exploring ways to promote diversity, equity, and inclusion in computing and related fields. In this regard, I have contributed to several initiatives advocating diversity and inclusion in computing. Over the past few years, I have mentored students who are historically and geographically underrepresented in computing and organized retreats, reading groups, and speaker series that give junior researchers the opportunity to engage with the community and present their work. As part of the speaker series, I have consciously made efforts and sought to invite junior researchers who might not have the same opportunities to present their research at conferences and workshops as others. Providing researchers with the opportunity to share their work will enable us to increase their visibility and recognition. Furthermore, I have worked to create an inclusive, equitable, and welcoming culture in my academic lab as well as taken on the role of student administrator to create policies for cluster usage that are fair to all students.

## 3 Expanding Access to Computing and Technology

As someone who has personally experienced the transformative power of a career in computing and related fields, I am particularly passionate about bringing more people from diverse backgrounds into the field. I myself started my academic journey in civil engineering before discovering my passion for computer science and eventually pursuing my Ph.D. in the field. By embracing and valuing diverse perspectives and experiences, we can foster a more innovative and dynamic community of researchers and practitioners.

With this in mind, I am committed to working to increase access to computing and related fields for individuals who may not have traditionally considered these paths. I am particularly interested in exploring ways to reach out to students and professionals from non-traditional backgrounds, such as those with degrees in fields outside of computer science or engineering, and helping them to discover the exciting and rewarding opportunities that exist in these fields. I believe that by

bringing in more people from diverse backgrounds and experiences, we can not only create more inclusive and equitable environments within the field, but also tap into a wealth of new ideas and perspectives that can drive innovation and progress.

## 4 Community Engagement

It is also important to me to use my skills and expertise to make a positive impact on my community through service and outreach initiatives. I have actively participated in programs that support underrepresented groups and am committed to making a difference. Some of my service and outreach activities include volunteering at local schools and community centers, participating in mentorship programs, and organizing events and workshops that promote STEM education. Additionally, I have been funding the primary school education of two to three underprivileged students in my hometown in India since 2019. I believe that by engaging in service and outreach activities, we can help to create a more diverse and inclusive community. I am dedicated to finding new ways to give back and make a positive impact through my efforts.

## 5 Future Goals

I am excited to continue my teaching and research career, and to build upon my experiences as a teacher, mentor, and community builder. I am committed to creating a positive and engaging learning environment that supports the growth and development of all students, and to fostering a culture of inquiry and collaboration that encourages students to explore new ideas and find solutions to challenging problems.

I am also eager to continue learning more about how we can further improve diversity, equity, and inclusion in computer science and in the broader STEM field. I believe that it is important for teachers and researchers to be actively engaged in this process, and to be willing to learn and grow in order to create more inclusive and equitable environments for all students and researchers.

In addition, I am passionate about expanding access to computing and technology for individuals who may not have traditionally considered careers in these fields. As someone who began my studies in civil engineering before transitioning to computer science, I understand firsthand the importance of offering alternative pathways into technology and research. I am committed to finding ways to bring more diverse perspectives and experiences into the field, and to helping others discover their own passions and abilities in computing and technology. To this end, I hope to continue mentoring and guiding aspiring students throughout my career, and to use my skills and expertise to make a positive impact on the field of computer science and beyond.